

c. 1948

The following is a faithful transcription of the typed/corrected copy of an original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

REV. FATHER STEPHEN, AS I REMEMBER HIM

"Shortly after our ordination to the holy priesthood--Fathers Damas, John, Fabian, Pius and Maurus--I was sent to the Sacred Heart Monastery in picturesque Yonkers, New York. Father Stephen who was about my age and had been ordained several years ahead of me and had preceded me thither at least a year or two and even then, though second to the Very. Rev. Pastor, Fr. Bonaventure Frey, seemed to be the popular Father and the Monastery--his bell continually ringing.

"From the very first he seemed to me to be a really earnest, zealous priest; always, not only willing but solicitous to help whom and where he might, without exception, high or low, rich or poor, learned or ignorant, Catholic or "Atheist." He was surely not over-talented. He had many friends among our non-Catholic neighbors over on Hudson Terrace, especially where the more wealthy and the "millionaires" were wont to employ Catholic girls and young-men. It would seem that he never failed to ask for the employer-master or mistress--of the house when he visited the employees. Later on, when continuing such visitations I found that many of these dear good people would feel slited if we failed to see them too. It just seemed sufficient to ensure employment if a Capuchin father sent any one over where there was work to do. Father Stephen was friendly too and was seemingly missed by the clergy as well as by the laity whenever anything important was on; even though he never seemed to care about making personal friends. In fact, unless he could see an advantage toward doing something to benefit, he was decidedly reticent and preferred to be alone. He was wont to retire (to) Jesus in the Tabernacle as often as convenient without being noticed, even in time of recreation. He worked hard on his sermons although he seemed always ready to take over any helpout that might offer itself. Even at that time he seemed to favor the idea of not taking over the conducting of parishes for Capuchins. He was disappointed

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